



Online laughter

Hahaha, lol, jajaja, kkkkk, rsrs... people around the world express amusements in different ways online.
<https://dgit.in/sep18-59-1>



How to make friends

A scientific study concluded that interactions with even casual acquaintances make us happier.
<https://dgit.in/sep18-59-2>

free hosting allowance. This would mean that the hosting services were paid for and FHH was aware of the content on these websites. While the takedown might have affected numerous other websites with purposes falling within legal boundaries, it did make one dark corner of the internet a little brighter.

FREEDOM OF SPEECH

The world is far from perfect, and this includes the authorities in power and national governments. There are quite a few countries and regimes around the world where currently, or sometime in the past, people have had their

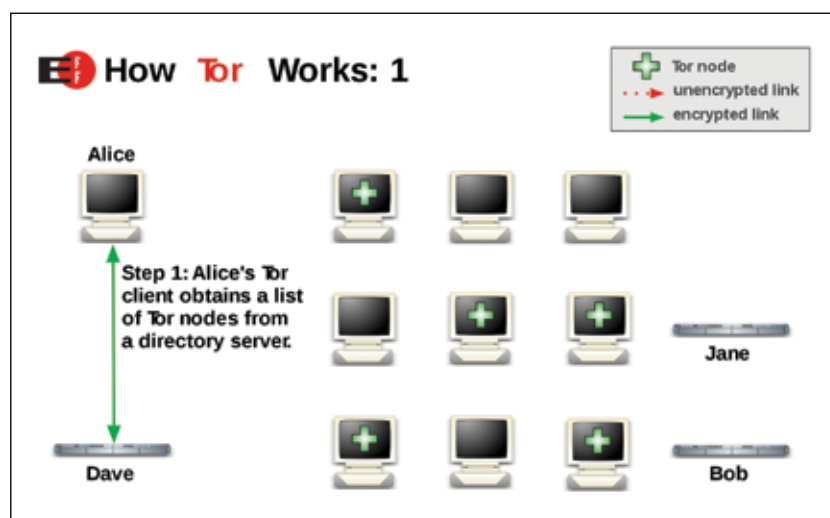
Cox for motherboard wrote a story detailing the rise of websites on the dark web in the Mandarin language. Even today, there exist anonymous chat rooms and message boards where users can communicate with each other without government supervision, and bypass the great firewall of China.

WHERE THE WHISTLE BLOWS

A constant knowledge, or fear, that most of us have to deal with online today is that our every digital move is being observed and mapped by a government or a private corporation. That, by itself, is undesirable. However, if you add a need to share confidential

for a number of high profile document leaks, including diplomatic US cables. Both Assange and Snowden have used the services of the Dark Web.

There's even a dedicated service to help whistleblowers keep information as leverage for security. Known as Dead Man Zero (DMZ), the service lets whistleblowers publish their information in case of kidnapping, injury or death. It requires the Tor browser to be used, and allows users to upload their data onto cloud storage. Along with content description, encrypted files are supported and site also adds its own encryption to improve security before generating a unique URL for the user to login. The user chooses an interval of time (once a day, once a week etc) during which the user has to login. If that time period passes without a login, the uploaded files are sent to a pre-selected list of email IDs. DMZ does not even store your data, you have to encrypt it, package it, and store it online yourself. DMZ just sends across the access information and the url, in case it is not accessed in time. There is a small price for the service. Essentially it is a digital dead man's switch.



How Tor works

freedom of speech restricted or completely taken away. One such example is China, a country where the internet is highly regulated and monitored. There are numerous instances of particular words being censored, particular websites being banned for no other reason than non-alignment with the government in power's views and intentions. Hence, the portmanteau Great Firewall of China that is used to refer to the country's legislative control over the internet is not surprising.

In regimes such as this, the dark web often proves to be an indispensable tool for people to maintain their right to express themselves as they please - even if it is to criticise the government. A few years ago, Joseph

information securely on top of that, the importance of a perfectly anonymous and untraceable platform becomes paramount. This is where the dark web comes in.

For quite a while now, corporate and government whistleblowers have turned to websites and services on the dark web to break the truth out without exposing themselves. At the same time, quite a few publishers and media platforms maintain dark web counterparts to garner anonymous tips and information that cannot be shared on the surface web for the fear of tracking. Edward Snowden exposed a number of global surveillance programs by the US NSA. Julian Assange founded WikiLeaks, which was responsible

A LIGHT IN THE DARK

There are numerous other individual instances of the dark web being used for the good. For instance, a certified medical practitioner, going by the name of Doctor X, informs people about the effects of drug usage and the details of how different chemical compounds, once consumed, react within the body. While drug abuse itself is illegal and highly discouraged by everybody, the information provided by Doctor X can prove to be useful to people looking to make the right decisions about their bodies and stay within the safe limits.

These instances show us that the dark web is not all bad. In fact, like with most aspects of the world of technology, it is a dual edged sword that comes with multiple facets. Sometimes, shining a light on the dark side shows that not all is bad in the hinterlands of the world wide web.